

CHEERY MOMENTS
A birthday party at Antara Dehradun

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**



"A 30-40 per cent growth for senior living players is nothing out of the ordinary. Most of them are aiming for these growth numbers"

ANKUR GUPTA, *Joint Managing Director, Ashiana Housing*

Ashiana Senior Living, Primus Senior Living Homes, Columbia Pacific Communities and CovaiCare, offer apartments in an affordable band. So if Ashiana in Bhiwadi, Rajasthan, has a 1BHK apartment for Rs 40 lakh and a 3BHK one for Rs 85 lakh, the CovaiCare retirement community in Coimbatore offers a 1,000 square feet 2BHK villa for Rs 70-80 lakh. Of course, the cost of an apartment may vary based on factors such as location, apartment size and the services offered. Seeking such properties are consumers who have a net worth of Rs 3-10 crore at the time of retirement and a monthly passive income between Rs 50,000 and Rs 1.5 lakh, says Ankur Gupta, joint managing director, Ashiana Housing.

These apartments can be bought and sold like any other property. However, residents must be above 55 years of age. In case of the owner's death, the nominee can choose to keep the apartment, rent it out or put it up for resale. The real estate providers can also assist with the resale in exchange for a brokerage fee. At Antara Dehradun, houses are sold on a lease tenure of 60 years, which can be extended every 15 years for a consideration of Rs 10,000. In case of the lessee's demise, the lease is transferred to the nominee without any additional cost.

Despite the age restriction limiting the consumer base, this segment is seeing growing interest from developers due to the fact that senior living facilities command a premium of 20-30 per cent over other residences, says Rajit Mehta, CEO & MD, Antara Senior Living. This is because these homes are designed with seniors in mind. "The infrastructure is carefully designed to make it old age-friendly," he says. The houses at Antara are built in accordance with the guidelines of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), with wheelchair access, anti-skid tiles, grab bars near the bed and on walls in the toilets, emergency call buttons and sensor-based lighting, among other things. Even the height of the switches, bathroom door locks and light lux level are carefully chosen. Other facilities, such as a resident doctor, round-the-clock nursing, an emergency response system, house-